

The Swinging Sixties

The 1960s was a decade of optimism, revolution, and glamour, in which young people rebelled against the values of their parents. They fought for freedom and change, and embraced new styles of fashion, movies, music, and art.

Teenagers in the 1960s wanted to have more freedom and fun than their parents, many of whom had been teenagers during World War II. As this younger generation watched the horrors of war—particularly the Vietnam War—play out on the new TVs in their homes, they wanted their lives to be different. The 1960s saw young people reject violence; campaign for nuclear weapons to be abandoned; and start the hippie movement, which stood for world peace and universal love.

Young people also began to challenge the authority and laws of previous generations. They called

for an end to discrimination and fought for equal rights for women and people of color.

People also searched for happiness, and experimented with exciting new forms of art, music, and fashion. This was a colorful and creative period of experimental art, revolutionary pop music, and clothing made to shock. The decade ended with an air of optimism when in 1969 the first humans landed on the moon, showing that anything was possible.

▼ TEEN FASHION

Young people in the 1960s wore bright colors, miniskirts, and shift dresses with bold geometric prints to show off their new-found freedoms. They wanted to be different and used their clothes to rebel and make a statement.



BEATLEMANIA ►

The Beatles were at the center of the pop music explosion in the 1960s. By 1964, "Beatlemania" had swept the globe and the "Fab Four" had become huge international stars. They went on to sell 600 million albums worldwide and to inspire countless other musicians.



◀ HIPPIES

Young people who had rejected mainstream life and wanted to experiment with new ways of living were known as hippies. They cared about the environment, and believed in nonviolence. Volkswagen Buses became popular vehicles among hippies, and were decorated with symbols of peace.